

CITA01 – FOUNDATIONS OF CITY STUDIES SUMMER 2026

JUNE 1ST, 2026

COURSE INSTRUCTOR: OLIVIA BERNARD

Globalization

Objectives

Discussion

Agglomeration
Economies

Global
Cities

Global Sense
of Place

TORONTO AND INFORMAL SETTLEMENTS

A Brief History of Toronto Encampments

Toronto Islands

Don Valley

Tent Cities and Protests

Further Reading

Curator Bio

Tent Cities and Protests

Need service in shantytown, 'mayor' tells city



The Globe and Mail, August 20, 2004

Tent-based informal settlements in Toronto have continued till today, emerging as a refuge for those avoiding the city's shelter system or a way to congregate during long-term protests. In the twenty-first century, their emergence is often defined by conversations about whether they should be allowed to exist, for how long, and what amenities should be afforded them. In 2004, *The Globe and Mail* reports on the mayor of a shantytown under the Spadina bridge requesting a porta potty and the city come to pick up baggage. The headline places 'mayor' in quotes threading the report with undertones of incredulity at the situation. The article is quick to note that this is only believed to be a temporary home by the residents in contrast to the waterfront Tenty City that was

bulldozed in 2002.



Until the Covid-19 encampments, the Tent City clearings were Toronto's most profiled and reported-on encampment. The

Until the Covid-19 encampments, the Tent City clearings were Toronto's most profiled and reported-on encampment. The documentary *The Mayor of Tent City* discusses how due to shrinking shelter space and a desire for more autonomy, an encampment was created on Toronto's waterfront was created. Tent City was established on a plot of land that Home Depot had left undeveloped. Due to media-fuelled anxieties about the encampment constituting a blemish on Toronto's image, suggestions of festering criminality, and paternalistic rhetoric, Home Depot under public and municipal pressure evicted those living in the encampments. Some of the residents were afforded rent supplements to support them after their eviction. *Down to This: Squalor and Splendour in a Big-city Shantytown* by journalist Shaughnessy Bishop-Stall documents some of the experiences in Tent City. The clearing of Tent City is perhaps the first recorded moment of such a large-scale informal settlement eviction in Toronto that mobilized both police and private security.

Courtesy of the Toronto Disaster Relief Committee Archives



Encampments were also formed to support protests. When the G20 protests occurred in 2010, an encampment was formed

Please watch - <https://exhibits.library.utoronto.ca/exhibits/show/torontoencampments/tentcityprotests>

CITIES & GLOBALIZATION

```
mirror object to mirror  
mirror_mod.mirror_object =  
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
mirror_mod.use_x = True  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = True  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

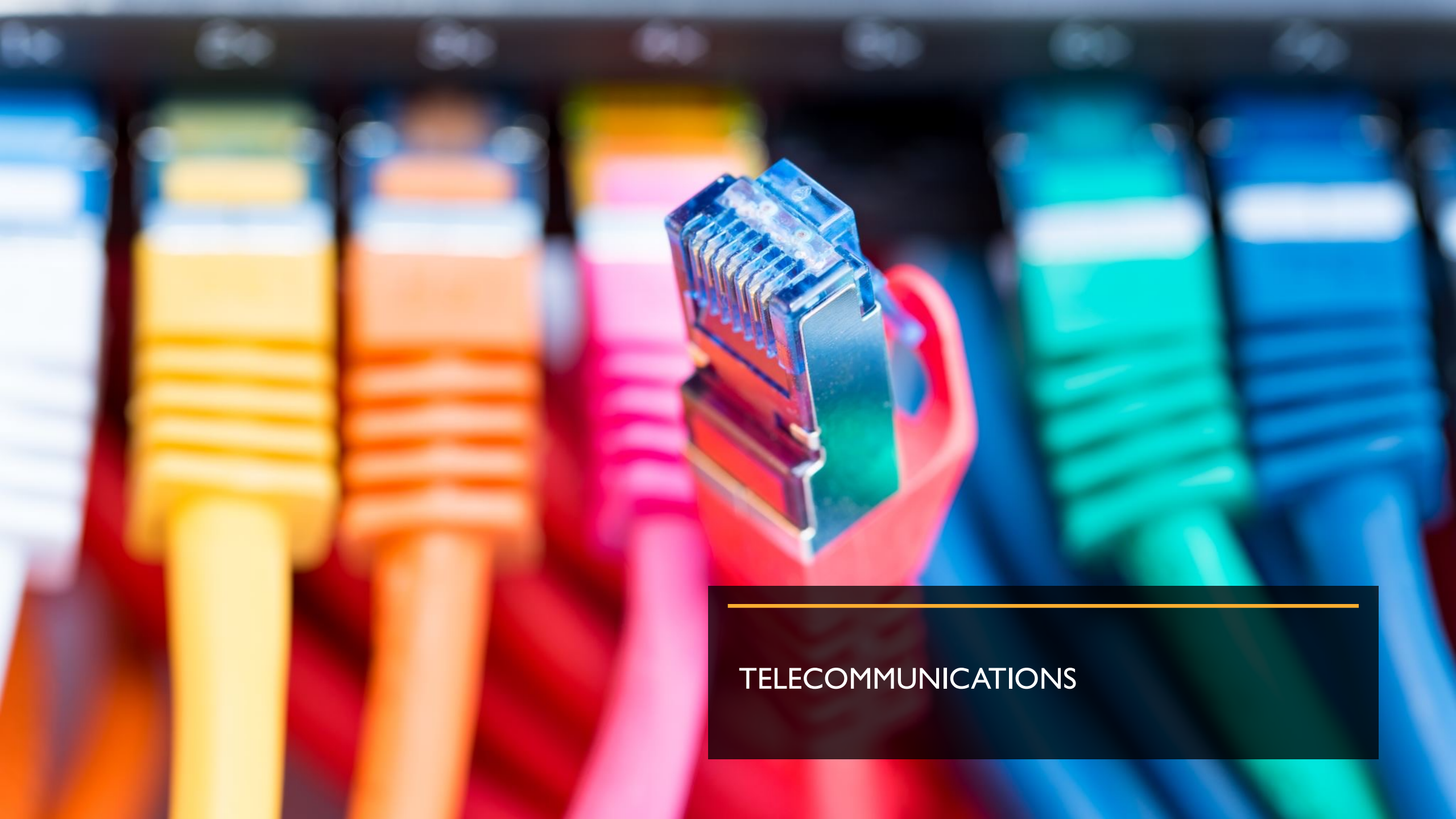
```
selection at the end -add  
mirror_ob.select= 1  
modifier_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.ac  
("Selected" + str(modifier  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
= bpy.context.selected_o  
data.objects[one.name].s
```

```
print("please select exactly  
-- OPERATOR CLASSES ----
```

```
types.Operator):  
X mirror to the selected  
object.mirror_mirror_x"  
mirror X"
```


GLOBALIZATION

- The process of increasing economic, demographic, and cultural interaction between people, companies, and governments in a global context.
- This results in greater global economic flows, global interconnectivity and increasing levels of inequality
- Technological advancements have changed how interconnected the world has become
- Is globalization new? What did we say last week?



TELECOMMUNICATIONS

The image shows the interior of a bus, looking towards the front. Yellow handrails are visible on both sides, and blue seats with a colorful pattern are arranged in rows. The word "TRANSPORTATION" is overlaid in white capital letters on a dark horizontal band across the center of the image. A thin orange line is positioned below the text.

TRANSPORTATION



CHANGES IN LOGISTICS



WHAT IS A GLOBAL SENSE OF PLACE?

LET US GO BACK TO MASSEY.

GLOBAL SENSE OF PLACE

- “In this interpretation, what gives a place its specificity is not some long-internalized history but the fact that **it is constructed out of a particular constellation of social relations, meeting and weaving together at a particular locus**” (Massey 2008, 262)

GLOBAL SENSE OF PLACE

1. Place is dynamic
2. Places do not have boundaries (in the sense of enclosures/borders).
3. Places do not have single unique identities
4. The specificity of place is a result of a distinct mixture of wider social relations

GEOGRAPHIES OF GLOBALIZATION

- What is economic globalization?
- Does globalization make the location of economic activity less important?
- What is the role of cities in globalization?

NEOLIBERAL GLOBALIZATION

- Dominant form of economic globalization today
- Characterized by increased deregulation of global trade, fiscal austerity, privatization of public resources, reduction of state services
- Multinational Corporations have significant influence



GLOBAL CITIES

```
mirror object to mirror_mod.  
mirror_mod.mirror_object =  
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
mirror_mod.use_x = True  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = True  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

```
selection at the end -add key  
mirror_ob.select= 1
```

```
mirror_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.active  
("Selected" + str(modifier_name))  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
bpy.context.selected_objects  
data.objects[one.name].select
```

```
print("please select exactly one")
```

```
--- OPERATOR CLASSES ---
```

```
def mirror(modifier):
```

GLOBAL CITIES

“These agglomeration of firms producing central functions for the management and coordination of global economic systems, are disproportionately concentrated in the highly developed countries—particularly, though not exclusively, in the kinds of cities I call global cities. . . . Such concentrations of functions represent a strategic factor in the organization of the global economy, and they are situated right here, in New York, in Paris, in Amsterdam” (Sassen2015 653)

GLOBAL CITIES

- Sites of leading global financial markets;
- Sites of clusters of specialized high-order business services;
- Sites for the concentration of corporate headquarters (transnational corporation and major national and foreign companies);
- Sites of most leading non-governmental and inter-governmental organizations;
- Sites of the most powerful and globally influential media organizations.

SASKIA SASSEN: GLOBAL CITIES

The emergence of global markets for finance and specialized services, the growth of investment as a major type of international transaction, all have contributed to the expansion in command functions and in the demand for specialized services for firms. **Corporate service complexes** are sophisticated networks of high-level financiers, lawyers, accountants, advertising professionals clustered in global cities. (2001)

THE FUNCTION OF GLOBAL CITIES

Global/world cities constitute an interface between the global and the local;



Global/world cities contain economic, cultural and political institutions that link national or regional territories and economies to global flows;



Global/world cities play a crucial role in organizing space beyond their national boundaries.



BREAK - 5 MINUTES



HOW HAS SPACE OR URBAN AREAS BEEN REORGANIZED IN GLOBAL CITIES?

- Central Business District in major international business centers is one profoundly reconfigured by technological and economic change
- Structures for economic power are being built in electronic space

- Saskia Sassen

IMPACT OF GLOBALIZATION ON SERVICE-BASED FIRMS

“The second process we need to consider is the growing service intensity in the organization of all industries. This has contributed to a massive growth in the demand for services by firms in all industries, from mining and manufacturing to finance and consumer services. Cities are key sites for the production of services for firms.

Hence the increase in service intensity in the organization of all industries has had a significant growth effect on cities in the 1980s. It is important to recognize that this growth in services for firms is evident in cities at different levels of a nation's urban system.

Some of these cities cater to regional or sub-national markets; others cater to national markets and yet others cater to global markets. In this context, globalization becomes a question of scale and added complexity.”

- Saskia Sassen

IMPACT OF GLOBALIZATION ON SERVICE- BASED FIRMS

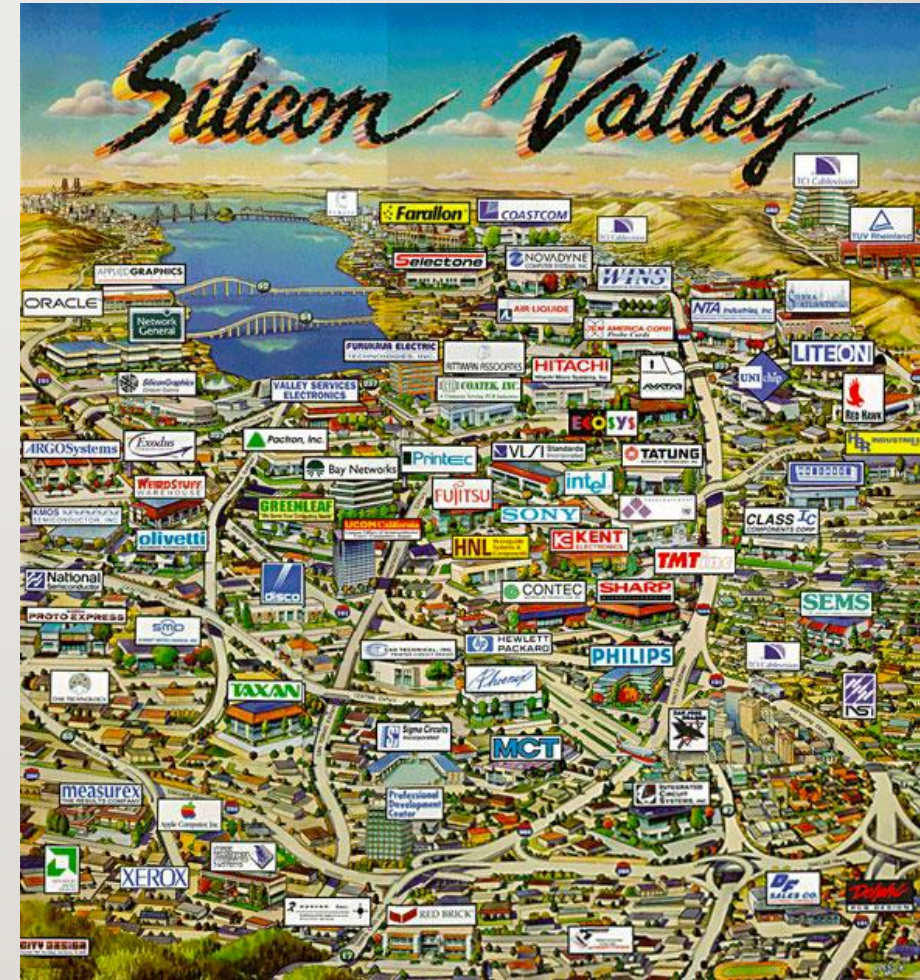
- “Growing demand for services by firm in all industries and the fact that cities are preferred production sites for such services, whether at the global, national, or regional level
- We see in cities the formation of a new urban economic core of banking and service activities that comes to replace the older typically manufacturing oriented core”

Saskia Sassen

An aerial night view of a city, likely New York City, with a dense network of glowing yellow lines and nodes overlaid, symbolizing a global or interconnected network. The lines form a complex web across the city's skyline, with some lines connecting specific buildings or areas. The background shows the city's lights and architecture under a dark sky.

DOES TELEMATICS
REMOVE THE NEED
FOR
CONVENTIONAL
INFRASTRUCTURE?

WHAT IS CLUSTERING AND WHY DO FIRMS CLUSTER?





AGGLOMERATION ECONOMIES

- Refers to the benefits firms accrue by clustering in the same place or region as other firms engaged in similar types of business

AGGLOMERATION ECONOMIES

- **AGGLOMERATION** is the clustering together of functionally related activities.
- **AGGLOMERATION EFFECTS** can be defined as the cost advantages (and potential other positive externalities) that accrue to individual firms because of their location among functionally related activities.
- **AGGLOMERATION ECONOMIES OF SCALE** exist when production is cheaper because of the clustering of a given economic activities. These economies of scale are external to the firm but internal to the region.

GLOBAL CITIES AND URBAN INEQUALITIES

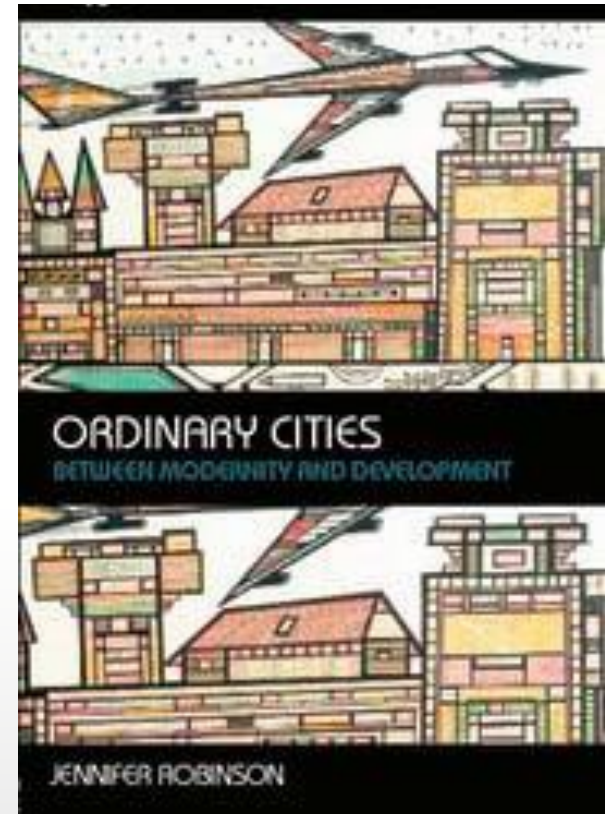
- “Economic inequality is sharply increasing – particularly in global cities at the center of the world economy.
- High prices and profit levels in the internationalized sector and its ancillary activities, such as top-of-the-line restaurants and hotels, have made it increasingly difficult for other sectors to compete for space and investments.
- For example, neighborhood shops tailored to local needs are replaced by upscale boutiques and restaurants catering to new high-income urban elites”
- Saskia Sassen



WHAT ARE SOME OF THE NEGATIVE
IMPLICATIONS OF THIS DISCUSSION ON
GLOBAL CITIES?

JENNIFER ROBINSON'S (2005) CRITIQUE

“... world-cities approaches have a strong interest in **hierarchies**, and have invented new kinds of categories to **divide up** the world of cities. Perhaps most **worrying for a post-colonial urban studies**, world-cities approaches, by placing cities in hierarchical relation to one another, implicitly establish some cities as exemplars and others as imitators. In policy-related versions of these accounts cities either off the world-cities map or low down the supposed hierarchy have an implicit injunction to become more like those at the top of the hierarchy of cities: they need to climb up the hierarchy to get a piece of the (global) action.”



JENNIFER ROBINSON'S (2005) CRITIQUE

“Global- and world-cities analyses have been enormously productive in refocusing urban studies on the wider processes and networks that shape cities; and they have announced a new, more inclusive geography of the role of cities in globalisation. But they have left intact earlier assumptions about hierarchical relations amongst cities, with potentially damaging consequences especially, but not only, for poorer cities. They have, in fact, consigned a large number of cities around the world to theoretical irrelevance. Building on global- and world-cities approaches, but mindful of these criticisms, other writers have turned to the ***ordinary city*** – diverse, contested, distinctive – as a better starting point for understanding a world of cities.”

IMPLICATIONS OF CLUSTERING

“the intensified clustering of transnational corporate headquarters and advanced corporate services firms in the city core overburdens inherited land use infrastructures, leading to new, often speculative, real estate booms as new office towers and high-end residential, infrastructural, cultural and entertainment spaces are constructed both within and beyond established downtown areas.” P.671 – Brenner and Keil





IMPLICATIONS OF CLUSTERING AND GLOBAL CITY ORGANIZATION

- Generate spillover effects on a regional scale.
- Changes in the local housing market
- Residential and employment displacement may be caused in the wake of rising rents and housing prices.
- Brenner and Keil

DISCUSSION

- Please check the discussion tab under the materials for this week on the modules page.
- Upload before the end of class - 1pm.
- Please respond in 150 – 250 words.

Which city do you currently live in? How does this city or one that you are visiting/studying in factor into the discussion of global cities? Connect to a real example we used in the lecture today.



NEXT STEPS

- Please ensure you have watched the documentary and completed the course article you plan to use for the assignment. You will work on the outline next week.
- You need to have a case study to properly participate in the tutorial.

